

MAN-10081

Teams, People and Performance



A group of diverse people, including men and women of various ethnicities, are seated around a large, round, light-colored table in a modern meeting room. They are all looking towards the center of the table, appearing to be in the middle of a collaborative discussion. The room has large windows in the background, and the overall atmosphere is professional and collaborative. The image is overlaid with a semi-transparent dark blue/purple filter.

Activity Time

Speed Networking for Group Work

Today you will have short conversations with different peers in the room. The aim is to get to know how others work, communicate, and contribute in group tasks. There are no right or wrong answers — just talk, listen, and move when asked.

How the Activity Works



One-on-One

You will talk to one person at a time.



Quick Chats

Each conversation lasts 3-4 minutes.



Rotate!

When you hear “rotate,” move to the next person.



Everyone Participates

No phones, just genuine connection.

This structured approach ensures everyone gets a chance to connect and understand diverse working styles before diving into group projects.

Tip: Make notes on your sheet of paper. For example, Swati - likes marketing, communicates via MS Teams, etc.



Round 1 – Getting Started

What are you studying, and what made you choose this course?

This initial round helps you break the ice and discover common interests or unique perspectives among your peers. Understanding motivations can be a great foundation for team compatibility.

Round 2 – Group Work Experience

When working in groups, what do you usually enjoy the most? What do you find difficult?

Reflecting on past experiences, both positive and challenging, offers valuable insights into potential group dynamics. This discussion can help identify complementary strengths and areas where support might be needed.



Round 3 – Your Strengths

What is one skill or quality you have that could help a group project?

Highlighting individual strengths is crucial for effective teamwork. This round allows everyone to showcase what they bring to the table, helping to build diverse and capable teams.

Round 4 – Time & Commitment

When do you usually have time to work on group tasks outside class?

Understanding availability is key to scheduling and ensuring equitable contributions. This conversation helps manage expectations and find compatible schedules for off-class collaboration.



Round 5 – Communication

How do you prefer to communicate in group work?
(WhatsApp, Teams, face-to-face, something else?)

Establishing preferred communication channels early can prevent misunderstandings and improve efficiency. This round helps ensure everyone is on the same page regarding how information will be shared and decisions made.



Round 6 – Expectations

Clear Roles

What roles do team members typically take on?

Accountability

How do you ensure everyone contributes equally?

Mutual Respect

What does a respectful working environment look like?

Discussing expectations fosters a shared understanding of what constitutes a successful and harmonious group environment. This helps in setting clear guidelines for future collaboration.



Form Your Project Group

Based on the conversations you've had, form a group of 5 people. Choose people you think you can work with effectively. You have 10 minutes.

This is where the insights from your speed networking pay off! Select your teammates wisely, considering compatibility in work style, availability, and complementary skills.

Quick Reflection



Group Formation

Was it easier to form groups after talking to people?



Surprises?

Did anything surprise you during the activity?



Group Confidence

How do you feel about your group now?

Take a moment to reflect on the process and the value of intentional group formation. This exercise is designed to kickstart successful team projects.